Woll, a very sharp and quick-spoken individual, worked on them for me.

Once, I remember, I said to Saul, "Listen, are you sure I am taking off as many deductions as I might be? Are there any clever devices you can use that I know nothing of?"

Saul looked at me over his glasses and said, "Isaac, when you hire me, I make use of the cleverest device of all."

"What's that?" I said.

"I keep you out of jail," he said.

And I reached out and shook his hand. "That," I said, "is a good enough device for me. Keep on using it."

12

On June 14, Horace Gold called me. He wanted "The Martian Way" but he also wanted a complete revision.

Horace was becoming crankier as time went on, and I couldn't help notice the differences in the way the Big Three editors in science-fiction—John Campbell, Horace Gold, and Tony Boucher—handled their rejections.

Campbell, as always, wrote letters that were verbose, difficult, and impersonal. He based his requests for revisions on content. Tony was always friendly and laudatory and based his requests for revisions on style. Horace, however, was becoming increasingly personal and vilifying in his rejections. 2

I had no trouble dealing with Campbell and Tony and generally went along with their requests if I possibly could. With Horace, however, I tended to become balky, and the crankier he grew, the balkier I got.

I remembered with annoyance the forced insertion of the U. S. Constitution in The Stars, like Dust—, the forced emasculation of the ending of "Hostess," and the long argument over "C-Chute." I refused a complete rewrite of "The Martian Way" and complained about it to Fred Pohl. I told Fred that, as my agent, he would have to protect me from Horace's harassment.

2 Horace once said to me, concerning one of my submissions, "This story is meretricious." "It's what?" said I. "Meretricious," he said, proud of the word